# Install the beta as its own app

Mech Sketch beta in a window of its own, with its own desktop icon, beside the released app. It takes about a minute in Chrome or Edge.



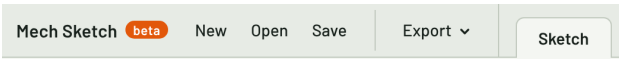
released app beta

## What you get

- An app called **Mech Sketch beta**, with the orange **b** on its icon, in its own window, on the desktop and in the Start menu.
- It runs beside the released app: both can be open at the same time, and installing the beta changes nothing about the released one.
- The beta keeps its own sketch. The first time it opens it starts from the released app's sketch; after that, work in one never shows up in the other.

## Steps

1. **Open the beta in Chrome or Edge: mech-sketch.org/beta/**
   The address ends in `/beta/`. Without it, you get the released app.
2. **Load the newest version:** press Ctrl + Shift + R (Cmd + Shift + R on a Mac).
3. **Check that it is the beta:** the orange **beta** tag is beside the name, top left.

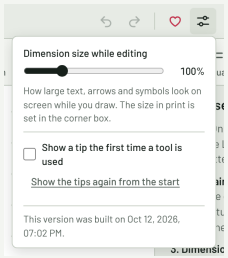



4. **Install it.** Click the **install icon** at the right end of the address bar, then **Install**.
   If there is no install icon, for example because the address bar offers *Open in Mech Sketch* for the released app instead, use the browser's menu:
   Chrome ⋮ › **Cast, save, and share** › **Install page as app...**
   Edge ··· › **Apps** › **Install this site as an app**
   The name is filled in as *Mech Sketch beta*. Keep it and confirm.
5. **Done.** The beta opens in its own window. Next time, start it from its icon on the desktop or in the Start menu.
   No desktop icon? In Chrome, open `chrome://apps`, right-click *Mech Sketch beta* and choose **Create shortcuts...**

## Keeping it up to date

The beta updates itself: each time it starts online, it loads the newest version that has been published. If something looks out of date, press Ctrl + Shift + R in its window.

To see which version you have, open **View settings** (the sliders, top right). The last line says when it was built.




## Sketches and files

Each app keeps its own sketch in the browser, so the two never overwrite each other.

**Save** and **Open** work in both. A file saved in the beta with something new in it, such as a plot or a spring, may not show those parts when it is opened in the released app, until they are released.

## Removing it

In the beta's window, open the menu at the top right and choose **Uninstall Mech Sketch beta**. The released app stays.

Or right-click it on `chrome://apps` (`edge://apps` in Edge) and remove it there.

## On a Mac

Chrome and Edge work the same way. Safari can do it too: **File** › **Add to Dock**.

Released app: mech-sketch.org  Beta: mech-sketch.org/beta/  Problems? The report button, top right in the app